

Medford School Committee Meeting Minutes 9.30.2020

Roll call: all present

Approval of minutes from Sept. 16 meeting.

Approval of bills/transfers of funds/payrolls.

V. Report of Committees

1. Rules, Policy and Equity Subcommittees: motion for approval of minutes.

Kathy Kreatz: looking for item

Paul Ruseau: Medford

Melanie McLaughlin requested that notes be sent to Kathy. Lisa sending. Jenny

Graham: Resolution in drive is complete copy of the resolution based on the output of the subcommittee.

Melanie McLaughlin: in summary, editing documents live during meeting.

Motion to approve: minutes approved 7 affirmative.

2. Melanie McLaughlin

update on BH meeting. approval of minutes: 6:51: 7 affirmative approved

3. Breanna Lungo-Koehn: 6:52 minutes approval tabled: 7 affirmative. **VI.**

Community Participation:

Ms. Sutter was not able to make it but emailed comments: (Paul Ruseau) comments on remote learning: too much zoom. All synchronous learning with breaks in some periods. Understand MPS is working out the kinks on this. I appreciate teachers. Parents are surprised as to how remote learning is occurring. Prefers periods of synchronous interchanged with periods of asynchronous learning.

6:58 Melanie McLaughlin: suggesting people participate by raising their hands or sending emails during meetings.

Megan Bayer: mother of kindergarten and second grader sending support of staggered hybrid. Emphasize risk of harm to students by missing in person school. Schools have been opened in Europe and outbreaks are rare. Although COVID provides risk, the hybrid plan addresses these risks. Appreciates use of three weeks of data as reflection of trends. Approves the metrics. Acknowledges great work of teachers and work of SC and David Murphy in a way that is safe and equitable. Sitting through remote learning with kindergarten – herculean effort on behalf of teachers.

VII. 7:02 Report of Superintendent – Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent

Thanks to school and district leaders, teachers, food service, custodians, transportation providers, nurses, etc. – all that have allowed our most vulnerable to return this week. We will continue this approach as we move towards the Hybrid Learning plan. Committed to developing more efficient systems. More efficient structure – sharing a revised organizational chart showing lines of accountability. We have been working since the summer to revise this structure. Working in collaboration is the leadership team: Dave Murphy, Dr. Peter Cushing, Suzanne Galusi and Joan Bowen. Bernadette R – Curriculum, Paul T, Lisa E all report to Superintendent. Gray boxes delineate bodies of work that the leadership team is responsible for overseeing.

In addition to the charge that the senior leadership team has, earlier this month, we as a leadership team met with the central office staff. Chart does not reflect the entirety of what makes MPS function. Critical to moving this forward, these systems include identifying better processes, capacity building measures for PD, improved recruiting processes, improving financial controls and better planning for long term objectives.

Announcement for community: free lunch at all school locations. In spring it was only at McGlynn. Now at all school locations. Even with remote instruction, grab and go breakfast and lunch for all students under age 18. This will also be posted with more detail. You can pick up a lunch and breakfast for the following day between given time at each school. Thanks to the food service staff for making this happen.

For Social Emotional needs, wayside partnership with MPS. Also for families, MFN offers things outside the book, 7-9.

For High School students, drivers education online through zoom is available. Oct 13 first class. Eligibility: Date of birth on or before January 12, 2005.

MFN offering STEAM inspired zoom meetings for 2 – 5 year olds in sept and October

Andrews – micro pantry has been placed. Another added at Temple Shalom. If you have a need, you can help yourself to a food item.

This month is Latino/Hispanic/Latin X heritage month.

Paulette Van der Kloot: 7:18 thanks for the updated org chart. Please post and forward to SC members.

VII.2 7:19 Toni Wray: COVID 19 update

Medford remains in the yellow. In preparation for the return of High Needs students, 263 tests were completed for staff. Today testing was provided for 70 staff members to prepare for the return of K students. Little traffic in the nurse's office so far.

VII.2 7:20 Recommendation to approve two donations to Roberts School

Motion to approve: 7:22

Donation gladly accepted.

40 Desktop cameras provided by a family. Gratitude to family for this generous donation.

Motion to approve: 7:24: 7 affirmative. Paper is passed.

VII.4 SY 2020-2021 reopening update

1. Report on air quality and infrastructure usage – David Murphy Prior to the arrival of high needs students, walk-throughs were carried out at each school last Friday. Reports as to air quality included in the folder. Air exchanges: amount of fresh air coming in and out of each room at least 4x per hour. All testing has occurred at all buildings except at MHS where it is ongoing. Retesting occurring in spots that needed repairs. Tremendous amount of work to but ready to bring spaces online according to the hybrid learning plan. Some teachers needed to move their classrooms because of lower tests and we appreciate their flexibility. HEPA filters have been distributed accordingly. We were prepared for Cohort A; many issues ongoing but we are working hard to get everything ready. We feel comfortable with the arrival of K students Oct. 5. Issues at one elementary school – may need to move these 3 classrooms. Repairs may be done by then but we need work to be done as well as the testing. There are pockets of issues but we feel comfortable with the arrival of Cohort A and K students. Lots of work to be done but it will be happening over next few weeks.

Paulette Van der Kloot: Understands how much work this is, appreciates dedication of all staff with getting this done to get Cohort A and K students in.

Superintendent Edouard-Vincent: We are prepared to receive K on Monday Oct. 5:
7:35

Paulette Van der Kloot: communication regarding this tomorrow?

Superintendent Edouard-Vincent: yes

Paulette Van der Kloot: Busing?

Superintendent Edouard-Vincent: yes – K transportation is ready.

Melanie McLaughlin: appreciates the safe return of cohort A. would like to ask about most vulnerable and EL students: transportation for EL students beyond the

two-mile mark? Has this been resolved?

Paulette Van der Kloot: was up at MHS signing the bills. Ms. Citrano said the bus passes will be available tomorrow in the front lobby where air flow is better.

Melanie McLaughlin: in what circumstances do students get support for passes –

PUT THAT ON

NEXT WEEK'S AGENDA.

David Murphy: Paul Texeira's staff has been working closely to make sure that all these students are supported. Generally speaking, we are working towards making sure students are provided with transportation.

Paul Texeira: all EL and Middle school students beyond two miles get seats on the bus. Only two days, he will be reaching out to teachers for feedback.

7:40: Melanie McLaughlin: asking regarding FERPA and most vulnerable students. Are students able to be identified as special education students because they are dialing in from the high school?

David Murphy: very important question, need to be thoughtful about. Trying to strike the right tone with the return of the most vulnerable but doesn't want to trivialize issues at each building. The tech infrastructure is sometimes an issue. Need to come up with a strategy for allowing students to zoom in from high school with privacy. This is a significant challenge we need to continue to work through.

Jenny Graham: what would folks recommend improvements in this area?

Paul D'Allava: as Mr. Murphy has stated, there are hiccups with infrastructure but we are trying to have students engaged with cameras on but trying to be mindful of home lives that students want to protect. These are norms that we are working on: whether to turn a camera on or not for privacy reasons.

David Murphy: there are many reasons we need to improve HVAC as quickly as possible. One of the many reasons is more students we bring in, we have more options. This issue can be more mitigated by having more spaces that we can use for hosting students.

7:47 Jenny Graham: Note to people listening that go – no go decision is coming later in the meeting. Requests a report of the hiccups that have occurred. Aware that we are pushing problems that were years and years in the making into a short time frame. We are not withholding information. There is no change endeavor that you go through in life that you don't learn from. What can we learn from? What needs to be mitigated that costs Money? Need to be honest and transparent about what is happening so we can deal with these issues in a more systematic way. Your commitment and dedication is not lost on me. You all deserve a round of applause.

David Murphy: point well taken that when you look at it in a context of a few hundred students coming in, there are short term and long term lessons. Speaking for the team, we finalized what we needed to be ready for cohort a and kindergarten. We are where we need to be. A takeaway was the importance of the walkthrough before any large group comes in. Seeing first hand, meeting with principals was critical to getting things done. Would replicate along each phase of the hybrid. In terms of how the org cannot operate at a fire drill pace, the org chart is step one to make up for structural deficiencies. The nature of bringing back kids is always a bit of a fire drill but we can ask how to better organize them.

Jenny Graham: there is a long range view and a mid-range view. Walk-throughs are important. As we move more kids in, the needs list will change and hopefully shake out and settle down. As it relates to reopening mid Covid, some sort of description of planning discrepancies would be helpful for SC to understand. Community has no idea of what David Murphy is doing. Lots of questions from the community as to why it couldn't be done sooner? Just asking for a few highlights in the short run and how they can impact movement in the future.

7:57 David Murphy a more structured response might be helpful. Summary has been provided tonight in regards to the HVAC memo.

7:58: Jenny Graham: appreciates the report. Would like similar information regarding the instructional side as to things that are working and not working.

7:59: David Murphy: No memo will ever reflect every issue that happens in a school

8:00 Kathy Kreatez: looking through reports: if a cafeteria is at a 0, are students eating in classrooms or outside?

8:00: David Murphy: either outside or in classrooms with open windows. McGlynn had the 0. The reports are fluid. Air balancing engineers are in buildings every day. We test, fix and retest. Bold numbers are revised subsequent to repairs. Our sequence has been in reaction to the emergency situation we are operating under.

8:03 Ms. Lerner (public comment): what an overwhelming experience it is watching you. Democratic process working. Hearing Super. Talk about Hispanic heritage day, Medford is changing for the better. Great that people are giving donations but why should they need to do that. Schools need more money. Lack of money not a lack of will. There is a lot we can do on the local level, but we need more from the state and federal levels. So great to see this behavior compared to city council meetings. Maybe because so many women on the committee. What an example you are setting for the community. City council meetings presidential debates are equally upsetting.

Paulette Van der Kloot; thanks to Ms. Lerner for these comments. Very difficult times on the school committee. Even when we disagree, we are all on the same page with our goals.

8:06: Motion to approve Superintendent's start of Kindergarten on Monday, October 5 (Paulette Van der Kloot)

Jenny Graham: have all the teachers expected to report next week who have made accommodations been contacted?

David Murphy: we have an agreement with free mandatory testing on Wednesdays. Even if someone is granted accommodation, they should still be tested. As we move down the line, we may adjust sequences but now we are having them be tested and then follow through with the accommodations. It is a small sub group affected because they can still be given a remote assignment. Affecting a small number of students.

Jenny Graham: when will we know if there are enough K teachers?

David Murphy: We know we have the right number of K teachers.

Jenny Graham: Have teachers already set up classrooms or will they be able to do that before the end of the week? Buildings have been open so it should not be an issue.

Superintendent Edouard-Vincent: we are negotiating tomorrow but considering an additional asynchronous time if k teachers need the time to set up rooms. We can redeploy custodians to help. The one school identified with challenges already has a workaround for that space.

Jenny Graham: wants to make sure it happens more than 24 hours in advance or return of students. Are bus routes ready?

David Murphy: No change in K routes. Look at the website to make sure it is updated. Mileage restriction not imposed for K. people can work it out principal and then our office to make those adjustments as needed. Everyone who requested a stop should be getting a stop.

Jenny Graham: thought we were adjusting to reflect 2 mile radius

David Murphy: if the bus stop was within 2 mile radius for grades 6 -12, then the bus would be eliminated. Grades 1-5 have a one mile radius. This was intended to allow for more space on the bus. Surveys had a strong response rate with less interest in planning to participate in bus service. If we have capacity issues, then we

will have to come back to the committee to make a request.

Jenny Graham: send out a communication about this.
Are food service plans in place?

DAVID MURPHY: yes

Are after school plans in place?

Suzanne Galusi: meeting with Megan Fidler Carey, it is a go for Brooks School.
Other schools only have two kids registered so they will wait for first graders to come in. So only starting at Brooks on Monday.

Jenny Graham: how does hybrid work in Kindergarten? Synchronous vs. asynchronous.

Suzanne Galusi: finalizing the communication on this after negotiations with teachers. We would like to provide time for them to join their classrooms from home. There will be suggested schedules that families can follow while providing two social opportunities throughout the day.

Jenny Graham: description should go out by noon on Friday. We need to get ahead of this conversation because we are expecting parents to mobilize on Mondays.

Suzanne Galusi: Couldn't agree more. Unfortunately, the timeline is extremely tight. Will get something out before noon on Friday.

Ms. Gass: K teacher: re the vote on Kindergarten. Wants to be clear for the three classrooms that didn't meet the air exchange rates. Going into classrooms made for older children. Would like you to consider that these kids are coming from uncertain home situations. She is teaching remotely so it doesn't affect her. No bathrooms in the classroom- it's a lot. Sympathy for those making these decisions but needs to advocate for these students. Since they have been learning remotely thus far, can it be pushed a week?

Superintendent Edouard-Vincent: thanks to Ms. Gass. After visiting schools with students, as an educator and a parent of a young child, seeing kids happy and smiling it is a sacrifice I am willing to make. Not talking about a large number of students. Ability to socialize is worth having to move the students to another room. Moving to next stages of staggered hybrid, we will not use rooms if they are not ready. For families saying that zooms are not working, we need to balance the number of children not succeeding with remote instruction, and will strongly advocate for the K students coming into the building. Needs of the children outweigh the inconveniences of adults needing to use another room. I was in all the schools and had positive reactions in each building. I Want more children to have that experience.

Mayor Lungo-Koehn: Hepa filters are installed so maybe the rooms will be retested and the rooms will be available to be used.

Jenny Graham: major concern is we still can't tell parents what education will look like next week. Hardship for families for them not to know what is happening. Solving the problem for kindergarten only solves kindergarten. As we prepare for hybrid for other classes, no idea as to schedule in middle school or anywhere else. We have got to get ahead of what the education looks like. Parents who made remote learning academy didn't want their children glued to screens. I am willing to vote for K but not future grades if we don't have a plan of educational expectations. Not supporting the three day out model.

X.9 Paulette Van der Kloot: 8:35 motion to approve start of kindergarten on October 5: 7 affirmative. Motion passes.

Mr. Murphy: question for SC: SC has endorsed approving Kindergarten on Oct. 5. SC previously approved objectives for Hybrid Plan Sept. 16. Oct. 13: is it wish of the committee to meet prior to the return of each grade level. We need to plan and identify challenges with expectations to prepare for Oct. 13. Is SC comfortable moving forward with next grade returns in the hybrid plan based on required parameters?

Public Comment; Felice Bailey: thanks for the work you put into this. Mother of HS senior and a mms student. Still in the yellow. What is going to happen with returns if Medford goes back to the red. Social aspect: what can we do about the social stuff about touching (high fives)? Concerned about the difference in socializing - safer with remote.

Mayor Lungo-Koehn: we will be approving metrics soon that will be on the website. Won't change decisions on a dime. Trying to make everyone comfortable and happy. Admin working around the clock.

Paulette Van der Kloot: Mr. Murphy posed a question that is important: the role of SC is to make policy. We made a policy. Unprecedented time warranting very specific concerns. I have heard thoughtfulness with which admin is putting kids back to school. Feels secure with letting the admin proceed accordingly but agrees with Jenny that need appropriate communication. Timeline: important that we give people enough time to know what the next step will be.

Mayor Lungo-Koehn: agrees with Paulette Van der Kloot.

Paul Ruseau: In theory agrees with Paulette Van der Kloot but so far we cannot tell people a few days before that their kids are going back. Expects to vote on whether

next groups go in.

Melanie McLaughlin: defers to participant:

Rina: parent of a high school student: all of this talk about last minute information has me concerned, but understands all the information that goes into this. Health is important for all. Question: 8:48: for high school: will students be in the classroom with teachers who are remote? Will parents stick to binding surveys if terms of contract change? Kids need to know what they are coming into when they do come into school.

Melanie McLaughlin: also hoping to be addressing this after Ms. Galusi's remote report.

Regarding Mr. Murphy's question, concurs with P. Ruseau that we need to stay secure in the Process of how kids will come in and how they will be notified.

Kathy Kreask: Re Paulette Van der Kloot, I would feel comfortable with admin making the decision on the October 13 return. Knows the admin is working closely every day with the HVAC vendors, comfortable with them reporting to SC on whether we are good to go.

8:53: David Murphy: with regard to timeline, SC established the timeline we are moving towards this week. Last minute communication will only happen if we need to have another meeting or if we need to scale back due to health parameters and HVAC reports. We are not as comfortable with the other grade levels just yet. Flexibility would be to scale back if needed. Communication would be to continue with remote rather than sending back into the classroom. People have been communicated as to what the hybrid calendar is.

Jenny Graham: Are we taking things out of order from the agenda?

David Murphy: Admin needs more direction as to how we can implement the hybrid plan? It is a threshold question.

857: resolution to move suspension – motion to take number 9 out of order. 7 affirmative

X.9 8:58 resolution go or no go on return of kindergarten students on 10.5.

Mayor Lungo Koehn: reads motions 9 and 10

Jenny Graham: final word would go to families no later than noon on Thursday. Gives an option to make a decision one week prior.

Mayor Lungo Koehn: can't vote on one week prior. Things are moving very quickly. We voted on staggered hybrid to get kids back. Doing it as soon as we can is important in case we surge again. Families are hoping these dates are on track.

Jenny Graham: we can put short meetings on the calendar to make these decisions. Significant concerns about the high school. "Minimum of" these things will become more clear. Proposed 10.5 meeting to make vote.

Paul Ruseau: voting no. these were aspirational dates. Supports a one-week prior decision.

Melanie McLaughlin: this resolution offers structure for parents, admin, and teachers. I have been receiving emails about the randomness of what is happening. We need a dynamic about communication. Historically we are having a major communication issue so we can fix it bit by bit. Seconding Jenny Graham's resolution about one week's notice.

Paulette Van der Kloot: motion doesn't make sense. Articulates we need to wait on the Wednesday metric.

Jenny Graham: color coded state metric comes out on Wednesday. We can't do anything about this. This can potentially change our decision. We right now need to look at whether MPS is ready for 1.....2.....3 etc. Are we ready with our controllables less than one week in advance? The Dept. of health metric is different from MPS controllables. MOTION is we are voting our controllable one week in advance? Regardless of the Dept of Health metrics.

Paul Ruseau: five public emails.

David Murphy: if this resolution passes, am I correct that committee will vote on October 13 since we are approaching the one-week window of time. Next Wednesday will be too late. If there are variables we don't have answers yet, can we say we are prepared tonight for Oct. 13, I would have to say no.

Jenny Graham: we will need to vote next Tuesday to make the decision. We will fly close to the sun next Wednesday. Can't go with all of this tonight.

Paul Ruseau: Monday and Tuesday are both within the one-week window.

David Murphy: if the issue is to make the recommendation tonight, trying to organize this. Looking for direction.

Paul Ruseau: most interested in a reliable method of making this decision. If we are waiting on MOAs, Bus agreements, HVAC reports then we are not ready to vote on October 13. Most interested in making reliable decisions.

9:22 Zoom crasher

9:23 Ms. Castignetti: teacher. Small special needs classrooms are closed. Specialists would consider working in the cafeteria but not doable at McGlynn. 9:24 Zoom crasher

Superintendent Edouard-Vincent:

Listening to the conversation going back and forth, we are working hard at the central office. Admin and teachers with the goal of getting kids in school safely. There are different opinions on this but over 60% of Medford want some in person instruction. I trust myself and my team. Given the information and the parameters that have been set up, we are working through issues to get kids back to school. I feel we have taken conservative approach, prioritizing health and safety of staff. We as an admin team have the information to make the informed decisions. These meetings can be very demoralizing. I had four reports to be presented. It is now over four hours. Every time we have a meeting, there is a ripple effect of other work that doesn't get done. Keeping schools up and running stops due to preparation. There are never short meetings. We are going in circles. We don't want people in schools if buildings are not safe. There are buildings with 500 person capacity with 30 students there. Not going forward will warrant other difficult decisions. What is it you are asking us to do? There will be something that gets sacrificed. There will be costs. We are ready for Oct 5. Information is ongoing. Community metrics will automatically make the decision for us. For a district of 4200 students, we can afford the 30 students at each building next week and take it one week at a time going forward. We relay the information as soon as we get the information. Capacity issue.

9:33 Paul Ruseau: The audience of these meetings is the public. He is demoralized by saying that things are better than they are. This school system has 50 years of neglect. We can't keep pretending everything is dandy. It is a lie that we will figure it all out going forward as we have been. I have 25 resolutions in front of me that I want to get done. We need to give a week's notice for people. I am fine with giving you the authority to make the decisions. The audience is not the administration. It is the public. I recognize you need to do the work.

Mayor Lungo-Koehn: we need to listen to the Superintendent and how the admin is doing.

Paulette Van der Kloot: admin needs to work on getting K in.

Mayor: we should trust the admin to do the right thing as soon as they can even if it is one grade at a time. We have essential workers planning on these dates.

Paul Ruseau: What you said is what I want to do.

Mayor Lungo-Koehn: we are in the middle of a pandemic.

Paul Ruseau: If we were deciding tonight that Oct. 13 was the start of kindergarten, that would be better. If we give it to the admin, I am not confident that the proper communication will happen.

Jenny Graham: There is a swirling notion that a go/no-go decision means that we are out of control. A go/no go is not an insult to anybody. It is our way as a collective to make the determination whether it is safe to go. Get everybody to come together on the same page about the plan we have. If you are asking me to vote tonight on sending the high school in, I would say no. tried and true mechanism in project management

Paulette Van der Kloot: I don't think it is about who makes the decision. Do we trust our admin? Jenny you are saying we need the SC to make the approval?

9:43: called X.9 and X.10 out of order.

Jenny: We still can't communicate what is going to happen at school Mayor

Lungo-Koehn: still in negotiation. Things get solved at the last minute. Jenny:

This is not how it has to work.

Mayor Lungo-Koehn: I wish it was easier for everyone but it is the state we are in.

Call the roll: motion: 9:46

X.10 THE SCHOOL COMMITTEE ALLOW OUR ADMINISTRATION TO GO FORWARD BASED ON THE POLICY WE ARTICULATED ON 9.16 REGARDING THE STAGGERED HYBRID SCHEDULE ADHERING TO BUILDING READINESS AND HEALTH METRICS.

David Murphy: Admin has the authority to scale back if criteria are not met. Intent of motion is to allow the latitude to make decisions.

Paul Ruseau: We have not voted on the metrics. Jenny Graham agrees we did not vote.

Paulette Van der Kloot: let's call motion and see where it ends up. If it fails, we will struggle with wording yet again.

Jenny Graham: NO Kathy Kreatz: YES Melanie McLaughlin: NO Mea Mustone: YES Paul Ruseau: NO Paulette Van der Kloot: YES MAYOR: YES motion passes

Participants with hand up.

Teachers: will we get the schedule ahead of time? There are specialists who are dealing with both remote and hybrid schedules.

Superintendent Edouard-Vincent: Hybrid schedule will be discussed in negotiation tomorrow. The draft hybrid is aligned with the remote schedule.

Suzanne Galusi: We have designed the schedules to work with each other.

Paul Ruseau: Email from the public:

Sean Beegan: SC is micromanaging this process creating more anxiety for all involved. Full confidence in the administration. Let them make the call.

JTaylor: teacher at McGlynn MS: questions regarding return of students. We don't have enough classrooms.

David Murphy: There are infrastructural challenges that will have to be met before we can make the decision with the phased approach.

Paul Malone Fulton St: remote 100 percent better than last year. Now I hear that teachers will have to teach both remote and hybrid at the same time. Will my kids switch schools.

Superintendent Edouard-Vincent: At elementary level. We have designated k-5 remote only teachers. Secondary level, we were not able to replicate it the same way. At secondary, more staffing challenges. Trying to make sure teachers with the proper licenses instructing the students.

Paul Ruseau: spoke with a Somerville School Committee member about this issue: they engaged with state vendors to provide the dese recommended vendors to provide the remote instruction. Have we purchased any seats?

Superintendent Edouard-Vincent; One vendor was completely sold out.

Peter Cushing: August 15 was the date. It was a significant cost per student per course. \$1.6 million to run a separate remote academy

Jenny Graham: M. Malone's question is a valid one. We don't have answers yet. What happens to fully remote students as we move to hybrid?

Another question about remote/hybrid instruction.

Christina: question about remote/hybrid cohorts. Will they be assigned different teachers?

Kate Willard, Florence St.: Regarding air exchange reports, how much notice did high needs students get about moving into other classrooms?

Dave Murphy: I referenced this in earlier reports, there were limited times that teachers were given little notice about moving classrooms. With regards to the timeline of reports, information coming in and continuing to come in as retesting occurs.

Suzanne Galusi: Enrollment report. More Homeschoolers.

10:09: Paulette Van der Kloot: I requested this information but was hoping to get a class size report (remote vs. hybrid).

Paul Ruseau: has anybody looked at “held harmless” regarding drop in students come next budget. Is it too early to be concerned about that?

Dave Murphy: No. Enrollment stability and growth is always important and a strategic goal. Too early to panic because many variables will play out.

Suzanne Galusi: In an effort to reduce numbers in the four oversubscribed remote classrooms, a letter went to families last week. At this point, no one has chosen to take the opportunity to move. We do have assistants in some of those rooms. Has been successful with remote learning, setting expectations and creating routines. We have had some responses about technology problems but they have been addressed.

Paul Ruseau: Not hearing anything is not affirmation that people are happy. People in those classrooms are not happy but didn’t want to move their kids in the hopes that it might be better.

Melanie McLaughlin: report on remote learning. I have a student on zoom for six hours. A number have reached regarding homework in remote learning. Up to three hours a night. How can we address this across teachers?

Superintendent Edouard-Vincent: Can you tell us about what level?
Melanie McLaughlin: high school

Superintendent Edouard-Vincent: for students taking honors and AP classes, they will be held to higher academic standards. I will reach out to unpack that data but unsure depending on which program of study?

Melanie McLaughlin: Is that appropriate in this setting socially and emotionally?
Looking for communication metrics with a gage of what this looks like?

Peter Cushing: Asked the parent to reach out to me. AP standards must be met. The

College Board is strict as to how these courses are run.

Report on Athletics protocols: Peter Cushing and Robert Maloney 10:26 Athletics staff and Toni Wray have put together a conditioning schedule after GBL changed the schedule to Fall 2 season. We have established protocols set within state guidelines. We have students conditioning at MHS. This week, middle school sports will come online. Volleyball will be played in three cohorts (one hour each) so they can use the gymnasium.

Robert Maloney: High School kids in second week. 151. 86 athletes at middle school. This is noncompetitive. Kids have the option of attending as many days as they choose. No cuts. Shout out to Rachel Perry who came up with this plan. Trainer available every day. Thanks for allowing them to play.

Jenny Graham: Motion to take 5 out of order:

10:30 Roll: 7 affirmative.

Post report on website in athletics tab; update on 10/15 regarding enrollment numbers.

Mayor Lungo-Koehn: can we provide a link on the website to the MIAA guidelines as well?

Motion to approve amendment are MIAA guidelines:

ROLL: 10:32: 7 affirmative

Revert to regular order of business:

ROLL: 10:33 7 affirmative

VIII. Old business:

VIII.1 Motion to approve Suspension: Tabled: 7 Affirmative.

Paul Ruseau: motion that we get paper packets again.

Superintendent Edouard-Vincent: not opposed to mail run/paper copies. Keep in mind the timeline. We keep running out of time. Hope to get meetings to a more manageable timeline.

Kathy Kreatz: would love a link to the folder. Prefers paperless. Paul

Ruseau: people have wasted their time waiting for this resolution

VIII.2 Alpha Med App

Motion to table by Jenny Graham. 7 affirmative.

Jenny Graham hoped to have this before Kindergarten.

VIII.3 Chromebook tip sheet

Motion to table. 7 affirmative.

X. New Business:

X.1 Rules, Policy and Equity Committee will meet prior to creation of the 2021-2022 academic calendar to determine observance of holidays and days off.

Paul Ruseau: trying to set up a process for the community to make suggestions about holiday. Motion to approve: MEV agrees it should go to the subcommittee. Supt. Responded to public emails to allow the public to contribute to this conversation.

Kathy Kreatz agrees it should go to the subcommittee.

X. 2 Resolution for MPS recognition of Yom Kippur and Juneteenth – goes to subcommittee

Amended motion on Yom Kippur and Juneteenth.

Motion to send both resolutions (X.1 and X.2) to the subcommittee. 7 affirmative.

X.3 School committee Resolution for notice to students and families of para/proctor supervision.

Roll to summarize/abridge 7 affirmative

Melanie McLaughlin: I learned that the most vulnerable came back to rooms with teachers teaching remotely and with paras supervising in the classroom. DESE has guidance that parents need to be made aware of this situation.

Motion that N1 letters (translated when needed) explaining qualifications of proctors. Concerned about shortage of proctors.

Melanie McLaughlin: I am willing to expand resolution to include non sped/el students who return to classrooms with proctors.

Motion to approve as amended: Roll 1056. 7 affirmative. Motion passes.

X.4 Approval of final metrics plan

Jenny Graham; I was hoping to have a revision to look at tonight. Motion to table: 7 affirmative. Tabled.

X.5. HVAC reports be posted on websites.

Roll call: paper passes 7 affirmative

X.7 Communication strategy - motion to move to subcommittee so we can get to work to begin a district-wide effort to develop a communication strategy roadmap that looks at current processes and use of technology.

roll: 7 affirmative paper passes 11:00

X.8 Hybrid model communication: motion that hybrid model be clearly defined to all grade levels of community.

Paulette Van der Kloot: is it appropriate to withdraw since this will be discussed in negotiations tomorrow?

Jenny Graham: no

Mayor Lungo-Koehn: Hybrid model 10/2 5pm for kindergarten.

Mea Mustone: this is just clarity for parents so they can know the expectations for the hybrid

Motion to approve 10/2 5 pm for notice of hybrid model to

Kindergarten. Superintendent Edouard-Vincent: 10/5 not realistic for other grades.

Melanie McLaughlin: it is 1, 2, 6, 12 we voted on

Mayor Lungo-Koehn: 10/2 kindergarten; 10/9

Jenny Graham: intent is to stop screaming into school with hair on fire.

Motion to table.

Roll call: no Mea. 6 affirmative paper tabled

Jenny: To the Mayor, who can I send these questions to?

David Murphy: one week prior, the hybrid schedule will be articulated.

Jenny Graham: we were told 10/5 was unreasonable. Not even worth it, there is no support for figuring this stuff out in advance. We wonder why we are losing enrollment.

If on the 13th, we are sending 1, 2, 6 and 12.

Superintendent Edouard-Vincent: I can't speak to the high school – too much data.

Jenny Graham: Air quality has nothing to do with this.

David Murphy: we are working with the goal of providing notice of hybrid scheduling and expectations 5 to 7 days prior.

Announcements of condolences followed by a moment of silence.

Meeting adjourned 11:16 pm